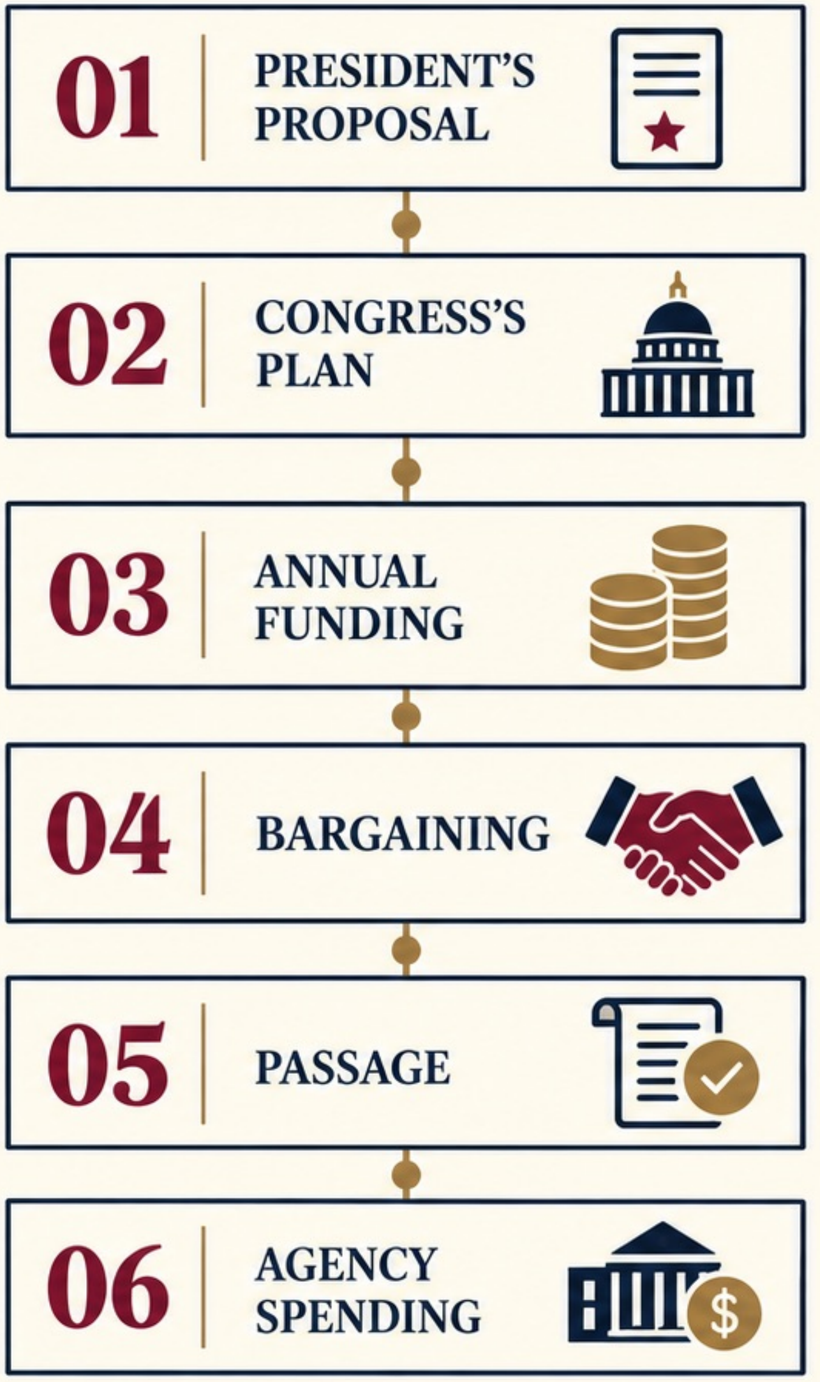
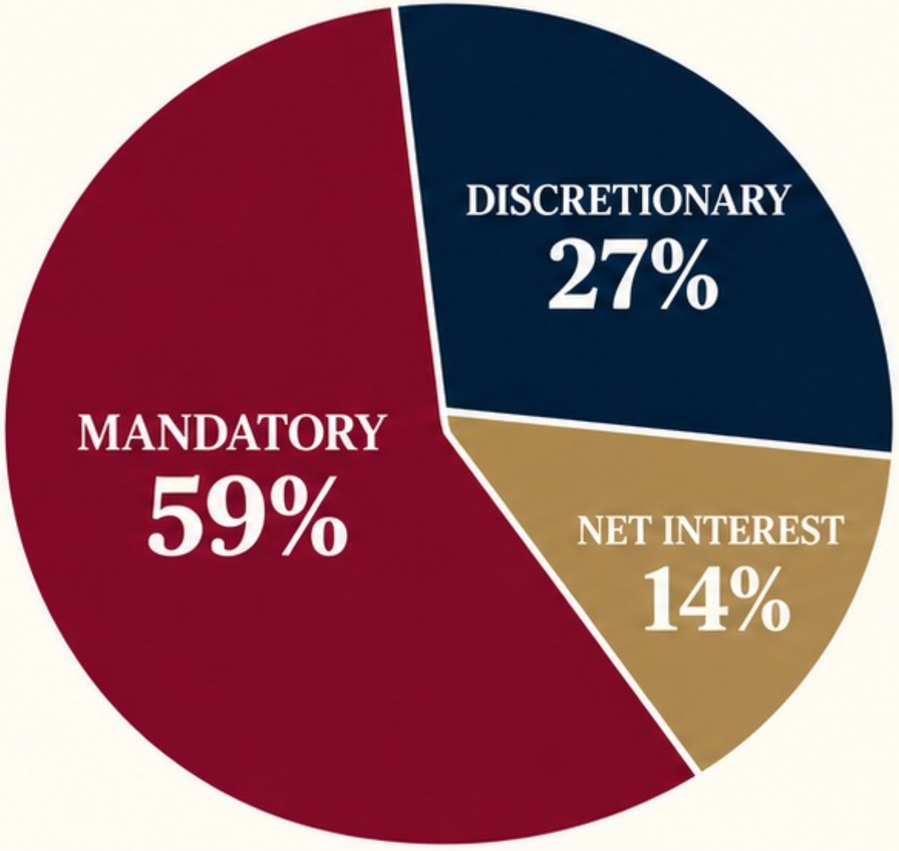
FOLLOW THE MONEY

The President proposes. Congress chooses how federal money is raised and spent.

A budget turns priorities into choices.



THE SPENDING MIX



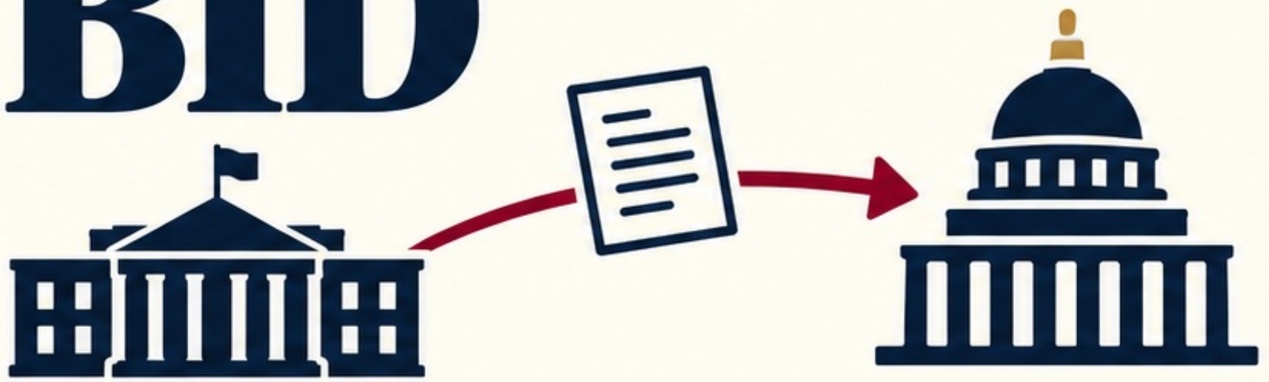
FY 2025 federal outlays • shares rounded

MANDATORY
59%
Set by existing law

DISCRETIONARY
27%
Funded annually

NET INTEREST
14%
Cost of borrowing

THE OPENING BID



The President sends Congress a proposed budget.

A proposal is a starting point, not a spending law.

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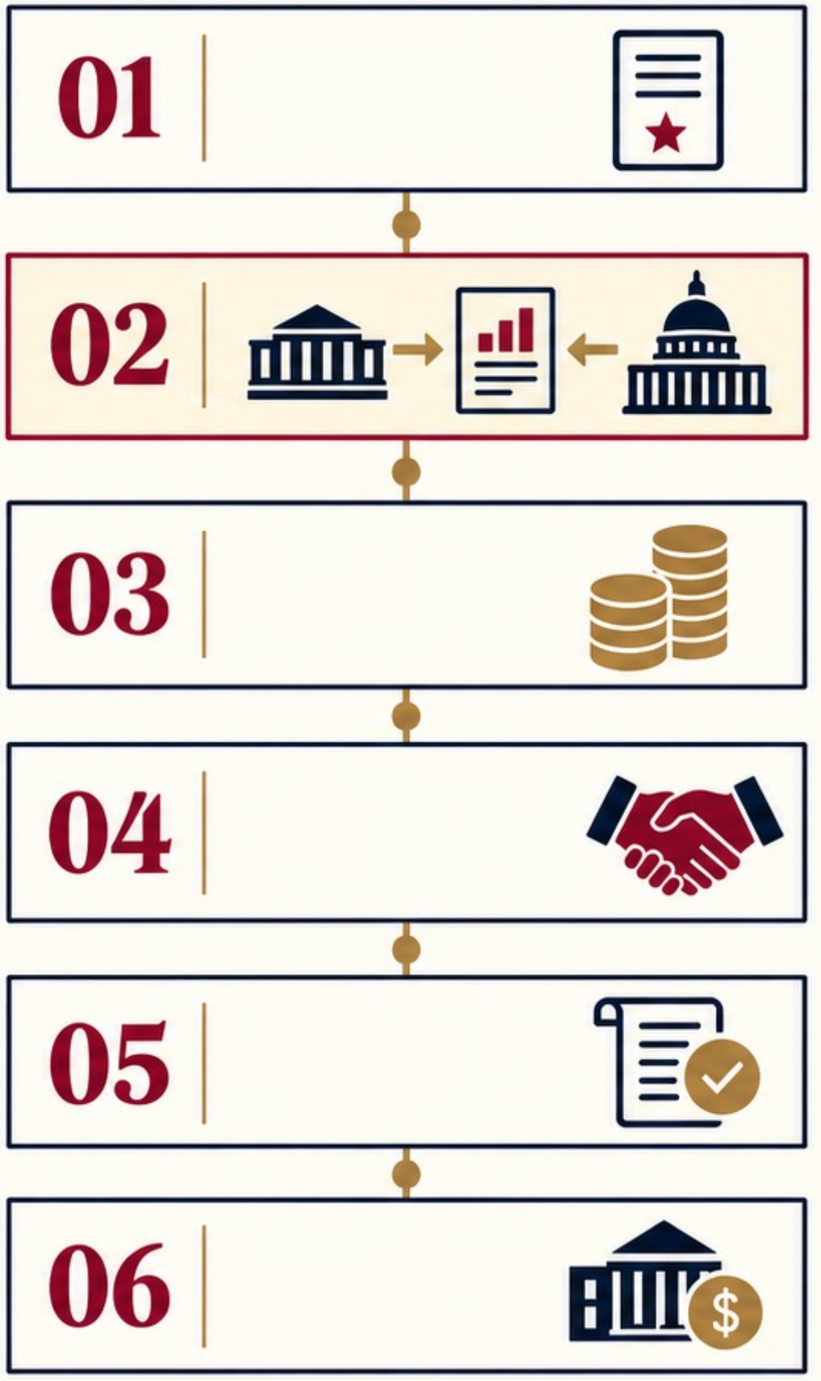
06

SET THE TARGETS

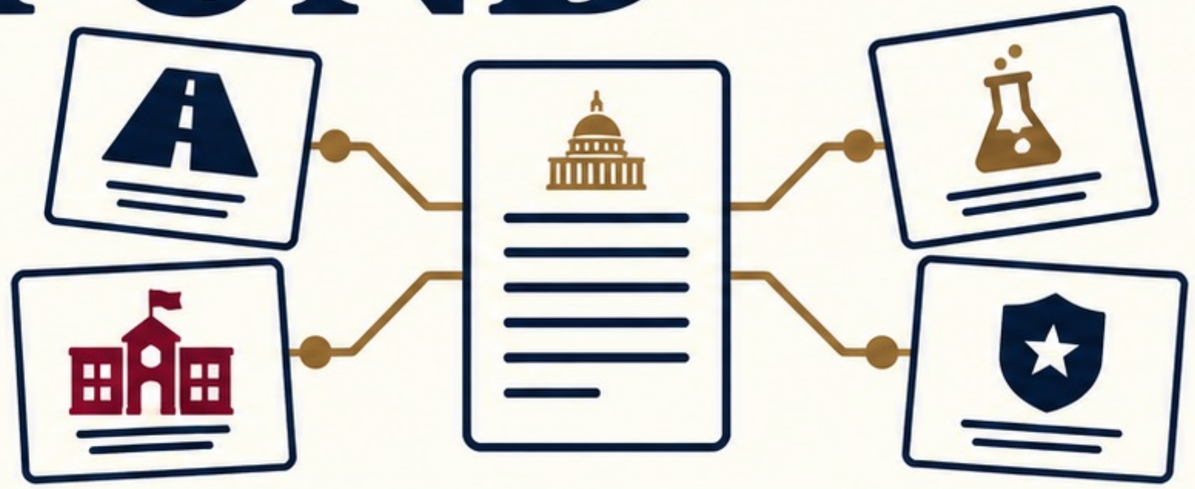


The House and Senate develop a budget resolution.

The plan sets targets. Funding still needs laws.



CHOOSE WHAT TO FUND



Congress considers appropriations bills.

Annual choices compete for available money.

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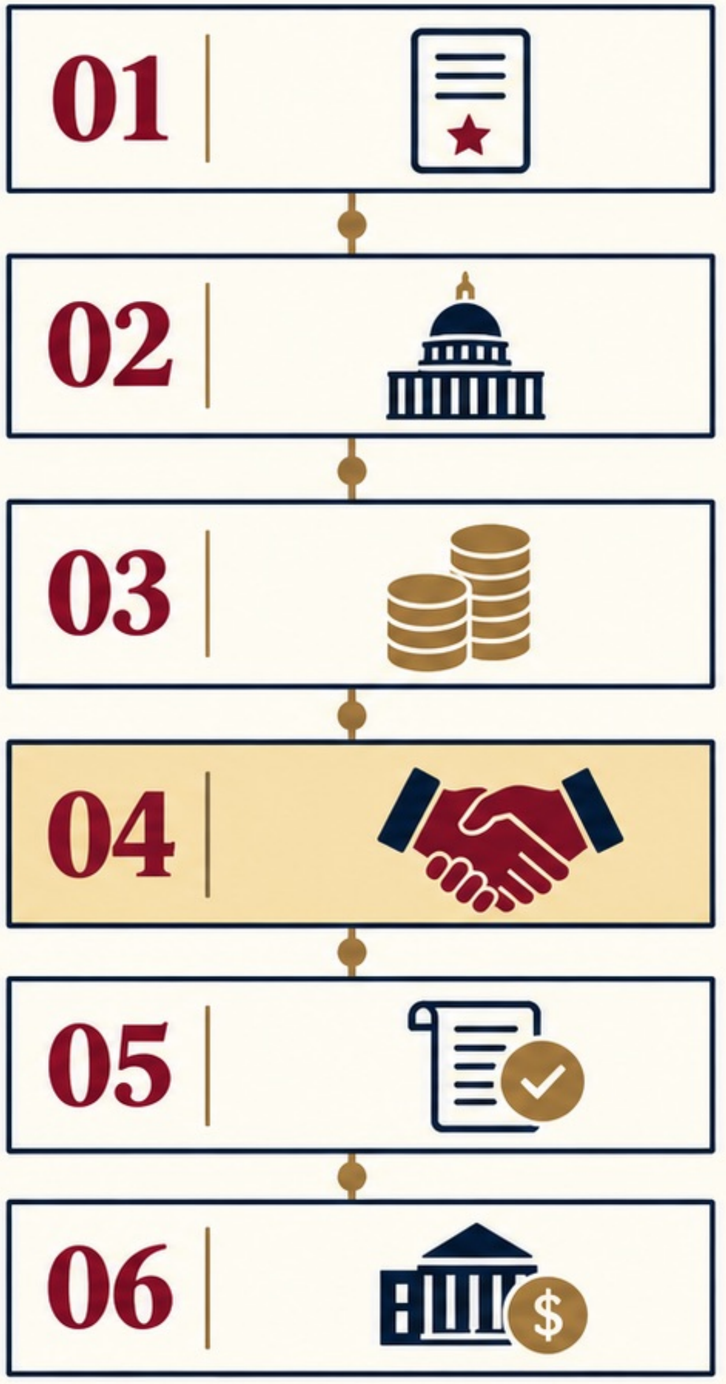
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TRADE FOR SUPPORT

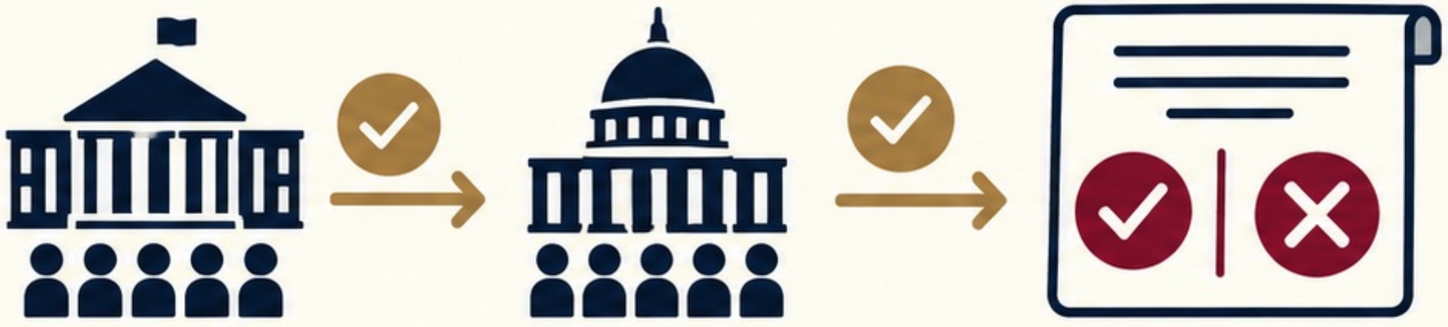


Lawmakers bargain over spending priorities.

The final package can reflect deals among lawmakers.



PASS OR VETO



Both chambers must approve the spending bills.

The President can sign or veto them.

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02

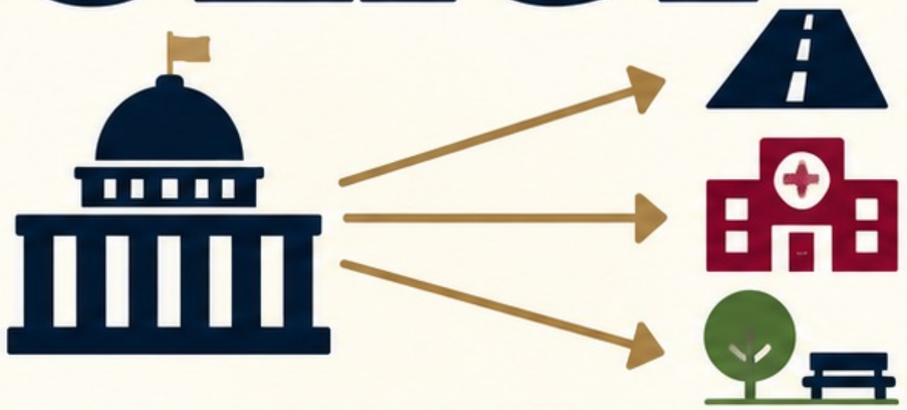
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MONEY MEETS POLICY



Agencies spend under enacted laws.

Budget choices shape what government does.

